Where You Are: Your Wife's Care Requirements, and Where Comparing Settings Comes In

The nine steps of the Family Care Roadmap, with yours marked.

When the names of places start coming up, it can feel as though you're already supposed to be choosing one. You aren't at that step yet. There's an order to this, and you're on step three of nine.

This page shows the whole road, where you are on it, and where comparing settings comes in.

Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1 **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
You finish with: Family Discovery Summary

2 **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
You finish with: Personal Care Assessment Summary

3 **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Immediate Action Roadmap

You are here. This step turns what you've learned about your wife into a plain statement of what her care has to cover. You're on its middle topic, Care Requirements: describing the help she needs and what any arrangement would have to be able to do. You finish the topic with three things written down: what her care team has confirmed, the clinical questions that are still open, and what you'd ask a provider to verify.

Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4 **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
You finish with: Care Options Comparison and Decision Record

5 **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
You finish with: Personal Care Proposal, Good Day Plan, and Monitoring Plan

6 **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
You finish with: Transition Preparation Pack and Confirmed Handoff Log

Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7 **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
You finish with: Care Team Plan and Care-Plan Alignment Record

8 **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
You finish with: Care Review Dashboard and Concern/Change Logs

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support
You finish with: Family Care Management Playbook and Handoff/Support Plan

What this topic produces

A written description of the help your wife needs: the tasks, what her care team has confirmed, the questions still open, and the capabilities to ask providers about. It is a family's description, organized. It isn't an assessment, and it doesn't name a setting.

You don't write it alone. The Family Caregiver Alliance's discharge guide says the hospital's point person, who may be a discharge planning manager, a social worker or a nurse, will look to the caregiver for history and insights. This description is that history, on paper. [2]

Where comparing settings comes in

At the next step, not this one. Step 4, Explore Options, looks first at the kind of care setting and then at how well a particular provider fits, and it starts from what you write down now. The National Institute on Aging puts things in the same order: the first step it lists for choosing a place is to consider the person's needs and wants. [1]

One more topic, Priorities and Recommendations, finishes this step before the comparison begins.

Who is involved, by role

- You: describing the help, sorting must-haves from would-likes, and writing down the questions.
- Your wife: what she wants help with and what matters to her about how she lives, in her own words.
- The hospital social worker or discharge planner: the planning for what happens after this stay.
- Her clinicians (doctor, nurse, therapist, pharmacist): the clinical questions, including nursing, therapy and supervision.
- Your care consultant: translates assessed needs into the amount and type of help required, and flags what needs clinical confirmation.

What this page doesn't promise

It doesn't promise how long a step takes, who will be available, or how any of it turns out. Every family's way through the nine steps is its own.

Ready for the next step?

You know where this step sits, and that comparing settings is the step after it. The care interview is how the description gets filled in: it goes through every area of your wife's daily life and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. Putting needs before places is also the National Institute on Aging's order, and the description of the hospital's point person is the Family Caregiver Alliance's.

1. National Institute on Aging, How To Choose a Nursing Home or Other Long-Term Care Facility
2. Family Caregiver Alliance, Hospital Discharge Planning: A Guide for Families and Caregivers